



Monthly Branch Meeting Agenda, Minutes and Newsletter

Wellsford Library - 11th May 2019, 10:00

Club Contact	Richard Paul	ZL1DP	rentdrive@xtra.co.nz	09 425 7233
President	Gary Ball	ZL1FAB	gary@theballz.co.nz	020 425 9902
Secretary	Ross Boswell	ZL1DRB	zl1rod@med.co.nz	
Treasurer	Paul Sole	ZL1VPS		

Agenda

- Members In Attendance/Apologies/Visitors
- Confirmation/Actions from Previous Minutes
- Correspondence In/Out
- Financial Report
- Discussion & Vote Regarding NZART Public Liability Insurance
- Members Platform
- AREC Report
- Repeater Trustees Report
- General Business
- Close of Formal Section of Meeting
- Education/Entertainment Segment
- Presentations

Members Present at Meeting

- Alan Dale, Ken Robinson, Mark Windram, Paul Kaufmann , Albert & Ria Olivier, Paul Sole (briefly), Ross Boswell & Gary Ball.

Visitors

- None.

Confirmation/Actions from Previous Minutes

- April Meeting Minutes and Newsletter has been received and accepted as distributed.

Correspondence In

- Newsletters and other electronic correspondence have been forwarded to the members by the Secretary.
- Letter from NZART regarding the Callbook and club members details.

Correspondence Out

- Various emails by the Secretary have been sent out, newsletters from other branches.

Financial Report

- May financial report via Paul Sole

Cheque Account		Fast Saver Account	
Opening Balance	\$2,815.27	Opening Balance	\$3,110.39
Subscriptions	\$250.00	Interest	\$1.80
Donations	\$50.00		
Total	\$3,115.27	Total	\$3,112.19

Closing Balances

Cheque Account	\$3,115.27
Fast Saver Account	\$3,112.19
Total Balance	\$6,227.46

- Reminder to pay subs (if you haven't already). Also remember that subs have risen this year to \$25.
- New subscription category for family/couples. This has been set to \$40.

Discussion & Vote Regarding NZART Public Liability Insurance

As you will be aware, due to an oversight by NZART (and their insurers) our club was uncovered by NZART Public Liability Insurance because RARC is registered as a charity. I duly presented the facts to those members present (see "The Way Forward" attached with this newsletter)..

We had three basic options in this matter,

1. De-register as a charity and qualify for NZART PLI – this is what NZART told us we should do.
2. Pay for our own insurance.
3. Do nothing and carry on as usual.

Option one would have cost us a majority of the clubs cash assets due to an IRD payment as a result of de-registering. The second option would have bled the clubs assets dry over a period of several years. The final option leaves us with charitable status and also our cash assets, we also have protection via being an Incorporated Society – liability falls on the club name and not it's members.

After a good discussion on the above, club secretary Ross Boswell called a motion

“That the Rodney Amateur Radio Club retains charitable status and does not take public liability insurance”

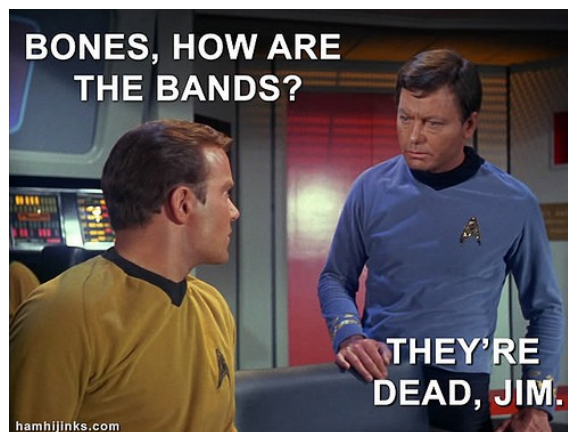
This was duly voted on and resulted in,

YES 7
NO 0

One other person abstained due to being undecided in the matter.

Therefore, the motion was carried and our club will remain with it's charitable status and all of its cash assets safe in the bank.

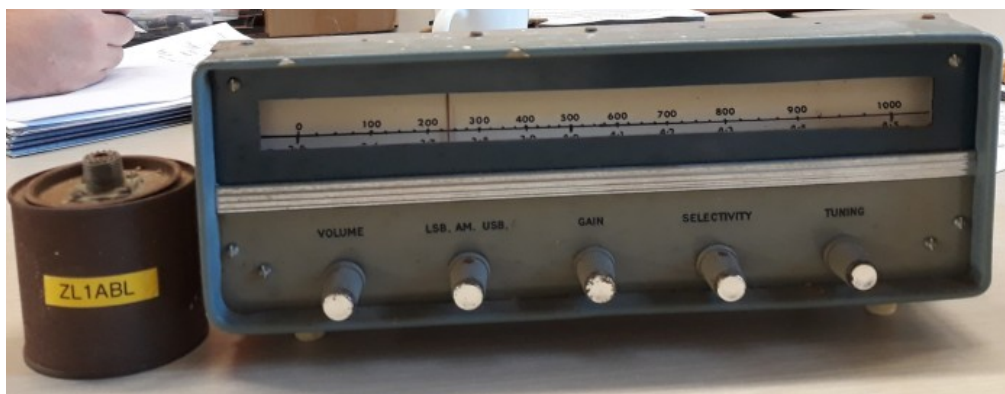
I think now is a good time to remind all members that as a charitable organization we can accept donations from anyone and those that donate can claim a portion of their donation back as a tax credit for that tax year.



Members Platform

Anything raised by club members or radio stuff you want to show/tell the club about.

- **Alan - 3.5 - 4MHz Radio.** Showed off his first transistor radio and dummy load.



- **Albert - Portable J-Pole.** Demonstrated his homebrew J-Pole made from copper pipe – that's a lot of copper there mate! It was also noted that the soldered joints on the copper pipe were nice too :)
- **Paul K.** - Showed us what looked like a spies suitcase. Apparently it belonged to Cecil and may have been related to repeater work which Cecil performed. Opening the case reveals a host of electronics which might have been some sort of EPROM programmer. After some research by Paul, it turns out to be a Microprocessor Development Board – <https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/MEK6800D2>



- **Gary – Crystal Tester.** - A good crystal tester/frequency counter purchased in kit form from Ali-Express for as little as \$8 currently. I actually used this to help calibrate/test my si5351 DDS VFO. YouTuber TRX Bench did a review of it - <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ksfha11Y0TI> and gave it the thumbs up!



AREC - Report and Activities

- Nothing reported

Repeater – Trustee's Report and Activities

- The repeater is working well and is putting out a strong and clear signal.
- The Repeater's online status is available online: <http://zl1rod.org>
- Net meeting is on Thursday at 19:30 on 147.300MHz. Duration is approx. 30 minutes in length.
- Our Net has poor attendance and needs your help. Even if you just pop up once in a while just to say hello it makes it all worthwhile to those who keep it running week after week.

General Business

Website/Mailing List

- Website continues as normal – check it out regularly, it's one of the clubs primary sources for information and resources <http://zl1rod.org>.

Formal Meeting Closed - 12:05

Next Meeting

The next meeting of the Rodney Amateur Radio Club will commence on,

Saturday 8th June 2019 at 10:00AM

Meeting Room, Wellsford Library

Education/Entertainment

- Alan showed a couple of videos
Portable VHF/UHF Repeater - https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=VMkULsNU2_A
HF Antenna for New Operators - <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=wG3oS-2QrFE>

Presentations

- None

Over and Out

I recently sent out an email about the NZ QRPers group hoping that it would rustle up some interest amongst our club members and I'm delighted to say at least one member, John Smart ZL1BEY (in the Winterless North), took the plunge and joined! At least we don't have to worry about what we will run into outdoors when we go operating portable in NZ!

Also, a quick note to say that Gavin ZL1GAM has been heard on 80m recently. He's just running a temporary antenna for the time being until he can get his permanent antenna arrangement sorted with the local council.



Thank you everyone for supporting the club. Enjoy your radio and radiate that RF!

73 and going QRT...

Gary ZL1FAB

General Information	
PO Box	Rodney Amateur Radio Club (Attn. Paul Kaufmann) PO Box 404101 Puhoi 0951
Contact Person	Richard Paul - ZL1DP Email: rentdrive@xtra.co.nz phone: 09-425 7233 or 022-1767458
Website	http://zl1rod.org Webmaster: Gary Ball - ZL1FAB Email: webmaster@zl1rod.org
Internet Banking	A/C Name: Rodney Radio Club A/C No.: 12-3095-0115508-000 Include your CALLSIGN and NAME